KAN VATAN

BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

a pilot for an original series

written by

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Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving and joining over time. These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER: **HATAY PROVINCE - 2013**

CRUNCH of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)
Baba. It's--

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
--me.

His fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold).**

DAVUT
Someone was chasing me.

She sighs, pats her father's back. *Sure, Baba.*

Then gently takes his arm, leads him up the hill...

...bare feet trailing red blood in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAWN

Red mud under hiking boots, 30km south.

A BACKPACKER (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

SUPER: **YAYLADAĞI CROSSING, TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER**

He bends to pick wild yarrow, revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck. Wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his pants, grabs his backpack...and walks down the mountain.

A SHRIEK pierces the sky. He stops. Turns toward the sound.

A JACKAL

bleeds in the forest. On its side.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow. The jackal SNAPS at him. But drops its head, exhausted.

He touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes relax. A moment of peace. Then he finds the wound. A bullet hole.

Shit.

A BULLET slices the air above them. He drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye. They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT through the trees.

He jumps to his feet. Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he TRIPS over a root and SMACKS his skull on a tree. Vision blurs. When he looks up--

RIFLES point down.

CUT TO:

TWO HUNTERS

drag the jackal through the trees...and the backpacker. Mouth and hands bound with rope.

Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a fire pit.

BLACK SMOKE rises into the sky.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

BLACK SMOKE fills a monitor. A DRONE PILOT watches the live footage. Flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:

Hunters dragging a jackal...and a backpacker.

DRONE PILOT
Commander?

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit. He feels heat on his back. Flames lick his bound wrists.

One hunter digs through his bag. Finds a compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A phrasebook - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT
Looks like a hippie got lost on the wrong side of the mountain.

COMMANDER
(sigh, sipping tea)
May God protect him.

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT
Wait.

On the monitor: The backpacker is standing. Ropes at his feet. The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER
Pull back!

WIDER SHOT

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving. Fire burning. No sign of the backpacker.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The backpacker sprints down the mountain. As he turns back to look at the drone, he SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree. But keeps running deeper into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

ACT I

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

The sun shines on Sezen, on her way out the backdoor. In her work clothes, she heads down the hill, stopping at a:

BLUE TENT

where she sees a sleeping bag, family photos, and torn pages from an Arabic-English teaching guide.

SEZEN
Günaydın.

MUSA is already awake. He's about 15, skinny as a cypress. He squints at the rising sun. Uses English:

MUSA
Morning.

Then *Arabic (italic)*:

MUSA (CONT'D)
Sabah.

IN THE GROVE

Musa inspects the leaves of an olive tree. The black spots. Sezen looks over his shoulder. She carefully picks a leaf - it crumbles.

HOSES

unroll from an equipment shed. Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots. She returns to the shed. Turns the valve. Water flows.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER THAT MORNING

WATER FLOWS as Sezen fills a glass. Then grabs a fat fig.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN
Drink.

Then splits the fig, hands him a half. He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit, but the BACK DOOR swings open. Davut emerges. Dressed for work. He inhales. Finds his way to the nearest trunk. Touches it.

DAVUT
The sun is kind today.

He looks at the shining sun, as Sezen approaches. Davut brushes her cheek. Gentle. Present.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
Your mother said to appreciate it before it goes away.
(face shifting)
I need to fix those spouts.

He walks into the grove. She chases after.

SEZEN
I fixed them. And the doctor is coming today. He said to rest until he sees you again. Musa and I can handle all this.

Davut stops. Turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT
I don’t like his old eyes.

SEZEN
We need the help.

DAVUT
Help comes for harvest. That’s how it’s worked for seven generations.

SEZEN
Baba. We won’t make it to harvest.

DAVUT
What would you know? You’re barely 12 years old!

Davut disappears into the grove...leaving Sezen speechless. With sympathy, Musa offers his half of the fig.

DAVUT (O.S.)
Tell your brother I need him!

She bites the fig. It’s sour.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
I’m at work.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data. Talking to Sezen. Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

SEZEN (PHONE)
It's 11pm there.

KAAN
Midnight. But Peter's on a warpath.
He's about to fire my new analyst.
Kid barely made it a month.

Kaan peeks into an office: boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I need to be on my toes.

SEZEN (PHONE) (CONT'D)
You need to be here.

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly. She switches to English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Everything is falling apart.
And Baba thinks I'm 12 years old.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen drags garbage outside. Gusting wind rattles leaves.

KAAN (PHONE)
He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN
No, Kaan, I mean--

She hears him talking to someone in his office.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Kaan!

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan quickly finishes his exchange with a colleague and returns to the call with Sezen.

KAAN
Sorry. Just tell me what you need.

SEZEN (PHONE)
HELP!

This is loud. He checks around. Sneaks to the window.

KAAN
Relax. I can pay for a--

SEZEN (PHONE)
Money doesn't solve everything.

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN
It has a pretty high hit rate.

No response. Kaan hears the wind whipping through his family's trees. It settles him. He switches back to Turkish:

KAAN
Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He already has one of those.

Sezen hangs up. Kaan holds the phone for a beat. Then sees Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Kaan looks under the stall doors until he finds shoes.

KAAN
Jimmy? What happened in there?

JIMMY (O.S.)
I'm a fucking idiot.

KAAN
(forcing patience)
You're not a *fucking idiot*. Just tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)
That my pitch would make good fertilizer.

KAAN
What?

STALL

Jimmy's on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

JIMMY
Because it's dogshit.

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

KAAN
No. Jimmy. I mean: why are you pitching Peter?

JIMMY
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell him about the chicken--

KAAN
Chicken? God damnit, dude.

BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I shut down chicken for a reason. Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I don't understand. It's a real opportunity. This bird flu is crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN
Exactly, "*the CDC says*". You're not the only one who can read. And this isn't fucking Fidelity.
(settling himself)
Listen. I know you're new to this. But we make money by betting *against* consensus. We have to know what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous.

JIMMY
And that's like...okay?

KAAN
What are you saying?

JIMMY
Nothing--

KAAN
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Mutters:

KAAN (CONT'D)
Fucking idiot.

HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Kaan marches out, right into Peter - who checks his watch.

PETER
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are you eating our fiber snacks? As you know, passing waste regularly and expeditiously is essential to a healthy body. And business.

KAAN
Jimmy has potential--

PETER
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER (CONT'D)
Find me something good, Kaan.
(squeezing shoulder)
Or I'll find someone better.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

The backpacker races down the mountain. Hides in a group of pine trees. Listens...nothing. Grabs a phone from his bag. Unclips belt buckle, pulls out a hidden SIM CARD. Slots it in the phone...SCREEN LIGHTS UP. Finds a saved number, calls.

This is ABE. But for now, he's known as:

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote. You're late.

ABE
I was making friends.

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
Civilians I think. By the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
But there were other eyes.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)
Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (AKA SNAPPER, height: 4’11”) watch tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Drone is border control. They just alerted MIT. Counterterrorism. Inspector Mehmet Demir is en route.

EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - SAME

A government-issued sedan drives to the border station.

EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - SAME

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge, revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

MARCY (V.O.)
You need to meet Brando, handle the delivery, and get back before--

ABE (V.O.)
I get killed.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY
If I were you, that wouldn’t be my primary concern. Remember, this isn’t Anbar. If you get taken, we can’t ask for you back.

A long silence on the line.

ABE (PHONE)
I know.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - SAME

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway. HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

WILL (40, AKA BRANDO) sings along with AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK on the radio. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest. He pulls over to the side of the road.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE
Brando?

WILL
(big smile)
You better hope.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER
He doesn't look like a terrorist.

DEMIR
And what does a terrorist look like to you, Commander?

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
It's been three months since the Reyhanlı attack, and we have zero suspects. We need to take every lead extremely seriously.

COMMANDER
We are.

He opens the door to the:

SURVEILLANCE ROOM

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering.

Watching DRONE FOOTAGE of Abe taking down the Hunters.

DRONE PILOT
Wait. This is my favorite part!

On the monitor, Demir sees: Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLDIER
Play it again!

COMMANDER
That's enough!

DEMIR
Do it.

Pilot looks at the Commander, who nods. He plays the footage. Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions. Notices the scar on Abe's neck.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

The scar on Abe's neck rattles as Will races the truck down the cracked highway.

WILL
You can unclench your asshole. It's only 48 hours. And I only get paid if I send you back alive.

EXPLOSION in the distance. Abe swings to look.

WILL (CONT'D)
Breathe.
(off Abe's confusion)
You know, with your mouth? In for four. Hold for four. Out for four.
(demonstrating)
I'm serious. You need to look like you've done this before.

Abe tries it. *In, hold, out.* His heart rate slows down.

Will slows down as a small checkpoint appears with armed men. Jumps out of the truck with a smile, chatting in Arabic. Opens the back, revealing sacks of grains and tubs of fuel. All branded with HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL.

5 MINUTES LATER

The aid truck drives away from the checkpoint...

ABE
Who are they?

WILL
They’re all hungry mouths to me.

...leaving the armed men happy with their haul...

ABE
I’m just trying to keep track of
who the good guys and bad guys are.

WILL
Look around, Coyote.

...and revealing DEAD BODIES strung up on a flag pole.

WILL (CONT'D)
The good guys are all dead.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

EXPLOSIONS on the news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR
Can you turn that down?

Davut doesn’t hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut’s leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
You need rest. Until we know more.

Davut pushes the Doctor’s hand aside. Rises unevenly. Ambles to the window. The Doctor knows better than to try to help.

DAVUT
**My father died on his ladder. It
was a fine harvest that year.**

DOCTOR
**I don’t like what you’re
suggesting, Davut Bey.**

DAVUT
You’re a man of science.

PORCH

Sezen hangs Davut’s laundry. Hears the conversation.

DAVUT (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Balance is a natural fact.

DOCTOR (O.S.)
So is death. Stay off the ladder.
Let Sezen handle things for now.

Sezen carefully listens for a response. Doesn't hear one.

After a bit, the Doctor comes down the stairs. Makes eye contact with her through the window. Opens his mouth, closes it. Then walks out the front door.

LATER

Sezen finishes with the last load. The sun is mostly gone.

KITCHEN

Sezen prepares her father's dinner.

DAVUT'S BEDROOM

Sezen finds him dead asleep. Covers him. Hits the lights.

Then hears HOWLING from outside.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen steps out. There's still a bit of blue in the sky, but the grove is dark. She hears the HOWLING again.

Musa scrambles out of a small tent. Alert. Scared.

SEZEN
It's that jackal. Go to the house.
(off his hesitation)
Relax. He's asleep.

EQUIPMENT SHED

Sezen opens a wooden chest. Pulls out an ancient REVOLVER.

IN THE GROVE

She moves deeper into the trees, gripping the revolver.

After a moment, she hears RUSTLING in the trees.

COCKS the gun as--

A YOUNG MAN named ROB emerges from behind a tree. Hands up. He's wearing a safari hat with flaps on the back. Shaking.

SOIL SAMPLE TUBES scatter at his feet.

ROB
Lütfen! Don't shoot. I don't know how to say that in Turkish yet--

SEZEN
What the fuck are you doing here?

ROB
Oh thank god you speak English--

SEZEN
(gripping gun tighter)
Answer the question.

ROB
I'm a PhD student, a researcher for Terrasource. I was meeting a local farmer and must've gotten lost. I didn't mean to cross onto your land. Is this the Yilmaz property?

SEZEN
How do you know that name?

ROB
I told you, I'm meeting with local farmers. We've been reaching out to your family for weeks. You haven't gotten any of our letters?

She slowly puts down the gun, processing.

ROB (CONT'D)
We can save your trees.

SEZEN
From what?

He's confused. *She really doesn't know?*

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
It's a blight.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - NIGHT

Sezen digs through the trash. Phone pinched to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Rob says it’s all over Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)
And who is Rob?

SEZEN
The only person I’ve mentioned.
You’re not even listening.

KAAN (PHONE)
Of course I'm listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan’s not really listening. He’s researching chicken prices.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I’m just saying it’s weird, he’s
probably selling snake oil. What
even is this company?

SEZEN
Terrasource.

Kaan halts.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - SAME

Sezen piles a few envelopes from the trash, for DAVUT YILMAZ. Unopened. TERRASOURCE logo stamped.

SEZEN
Do you know them?
(getting nothing)
Kaan? Listen to me.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan is definitely listening now. On monitors: Terrasource stock. Research on olive trees and diseases.

KAAN
I know them. Why are they in Hatay?

SEZEN
THE BLIGHT. This is what I’m
telling you. They have a cure.

KAAN
Does it work?

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

SEZEN
Yes. Half the groves in the district have done it already. And they've offered to do it for us. They provide the scion wood and do all the grafting themselves.

KAAN
What. No.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - SAME

Sezen does NOT like this tone.

SEZEN
It costs us nothing.

KAAN
Nothing costs nothing. These firms are ruthless in developing markets. They'll take the land right from under us. Tell me Baba's not actually considering this.

Through the window, Sezen sees Davut descending the stairs.

SEZEN
He's not.

KAAN
Promise me you won't let him sign anything. Promise me you won't take anything without my approval.

SEZEN
(jaw locking)
Of course, brother.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan looks at Peter's office. Throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN
What do you know about olive trees?

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Sezen returns inside with several letters from TERRASOURCE. Davut's sitting at the table. He seems unusually lucid.

SEZEN
What are these?

DAVUT
Garbage. I need a bath.

Sezen opens one of the letters. There's a contract inside.

SEZEN
Why wouldn't you tell me?

DAVUT
I shouldn't have to tell you about the hungry predators. Now put that in the trash where it belongs.

Davut gets to his feet, nods to the contract. Ambles off.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
And tell Sezen to fill the tub.

BATHTUB - LATER

Sezen helps her father into the bath.

Runs a cloth over him. Lifts his foot out of the water. The sole is cut open from the hillside. She cleans the wound. He winces. Lets her. The water turns pink.

When he's finished, she wraps him in a towel.

DAVUT'S BEDROOM - AFTER THAT

Sezen puts him to bed. On her way out:

DAVUT
Sezen. We have a responsibility to make hard choices for our family. Even when we disagree.

Sezen turns out the lights. Closes the door.

KITCHEN

Sezen looks at the contract on the table.

Then signs the name DAVUT YILMAZ.

ACT II

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

LEYLA (22) chops vegetables. Dumps them in lamb stew. Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency.

She reaches for spices on a high shelf, revealing a thick scar around her ankle. Like a chain.

A TRUCK RUMBLES to the house. She smooths her skirt.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - SAME

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND. RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

Abe follows Will inside. It’s nice. Tile floors, high ceilings, a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL
No “one”. Just “half hour”.

Will grabs a bottle of Arak, nods for Abe to follow outside.

Leyla studies Abe as he passes.

EXT. WILL’S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in darkness. Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

WILL
I’m helping with her English. She thinks she’s gonna move to America.

ABE
No family?

WILL
She’s got a kid brother working some olive grove in Hatay. The rest are dead. If they’re lucky.

Abe follows Will’s eyes back to the kitchen window, where Leyla’s watching. She quickly turns away.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on the fence.

WILL
Jackals. They smell the dead.
(quiet, serious)
Can I tell you a secret?
(sniff)
I smell it too.

He holds the tension. Then playfully ZAPS the prod in front of Abe’s face and laughs, then finishes his drink.

INT. WILL’S COMPOUND - LEYLA’S ROOM - SAME

LIGHTS ON as Leyla sits at her small desk.

Sets down her workbook, knocking out:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings. And a map. Their location in Syria circled. With a line that goes across the border...to Hatay Province.

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
It’s a trail of death.

INT. HEDGE FUND - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay Province.

Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I tracked social media complaints about dying trees and matched them to satellite imaging. The disease is coming from the border.

KAAN
And Terrasource?

JIMMY
They already sell disease-resistant cultivars in Spain and Greece. But there’s no public info about their entry into Turkey.

Jimmy smirks.

KAAN
So why are you smiling?

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo. "Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

JIMMY
This is the same team that did their phase one testing in Greece. Look where they are.

Kaan scans the photo. Behind the group, there's a road sign with distance markers for GAZIANTEP and ADANA. Then he looks back at the group. The faces. Then the caption with the names, including: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE.

KAAN
Hello *Rob*.

JIMMY
You know him?

Kaan smirks and jumps to his feet.

KAAN
Compile the research. Now.
(slapping Jimmy's back)
We take this to Peter tonight.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DRIVEWAY - MORNING

Rob unloads his rental car. Ladder. Grafting knives. A cooler of scion wood wrapped in wet burlap.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - SAME

Sezen watches Rob unloading from Davut's window.

Her father turns over in bed. She quickly closes the shades. Then unplugs his alarm clock, and kisses him on the head.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - SAME

Sezen leads Rob into the grove. Voice low.

SEZEN
Start in the far rows.

ROB
The worst trees are by the house.

SEZEN
Just start with the far rows.

Rob looks at Davut's shuttered window. Back at Sezen.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
He's not feeling well. I don't want to wake him up.

Sezen lets Rob go ahead. Peels off to find Musa at the shed.

SEZEN
If Baba wakes up, come find me.
(off his confusion)
Father come, you say.

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - MORNING

LIGHT from Demir's cell phone flashes. The name "ELIF". It's early. But Demir hasn't slept. He's studying evidence of the Reyhanlı car bombings pinned to his wall. Surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

The phone rings out. Then starts ringing again. He sighs.

A FEW MINUTES LATER

Demir speaks with his daughter, ELIF.

ELIF (PHONE)
But it's on Saturday. You promised.

DEMIR
I said I would do my best.

ELIF (PHONE)
Well do better, Baba. This is my graduation.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)
And this is my job. Please don't make it harder than it needs to be.

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - SAME

Call ends. Demir sighs, puts down the phone.

Looks at a photo on his wall. Abe's face, from drone footage.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe looks out the window. To the ocean.

Will's truck is finally arriving at the PORT. Cranes GROAN overhead. Armed guards milling about.

WILL
Stay in the truck.

A FERRY docks ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck. A customs OFFICER greets Will with kisses on both cheeks.

MINUTES LATER

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

MARCY (PHONE)
Brando's behaving himself?

DOCKWORKERS move crates from ferry to Will's aid truck. Food supplies on top. Will supervises. Joking with the Officer.

Beneath the food: STEEL GLIMMERS in the sunlight.

ABE
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)
I trust his incentives. He's not one of ours.

ABE
Neither am I.
(off her silence)
Just explain how I get out of here tomorrow. Will MIT be looking for me at the border?

MARCY (PHONE)
We'll send you the other way.

ABE
What. No. I'm not going back--

MARCY (PHONE)
We don't have a choice. If you get picked up in Syria--

ABE
(opening door)
I know.

LOADING DOCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe slams the door of the truck. Heads for a bathroom.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind.

Abe SPINS and body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG GUARD. Barely twenty. Confused.

WILL (O.S.)
Easy.

Will wraps Abe around the hips. Smiles at the guard.

BACK IN THE TRUCK - A MINUTE LATER

Will slams the door from inside.

WILL
I said stay in the truck.

ABE
I have to piss.

WILL
And I have to keep you alive.

SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A CUSTOMS OFFICER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewinds to Abe’s near-fight.

He pauses on Abe’s face. Picks up a phone.

INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Peter does pull-ups. Kaan and Jimmy in chairs, pitching.

PETER
Curing sick trees. I didn’t realize we were a charity.

KAAN
We're an opportunistic hedge fund, and *this* is a lucrative opportunity. The disease is wrecking acres of profitable land the size of small countries. And nobody else with Terrasource's capabilities is present in the region. Whatever they have, they're years ahead of the competition.

PETER
Whatever they have, they haven't announced publicly.

Peter hops off the bar. Flops behind his desk.

PETER (CONT'D)
Making this purely speculative. Unless there's something you're not sharing with me?

Kaan and Jimmy exchange a look.

PETER
Jimmy. Get us coffee.

JIMMY
I thought you didn't drink caff--

Peter glares at him. He scurries out. Kaan opens his mouth--

PETER
Don't speak. Is it real or not?

Kaan nods. It's real.

PETER (CONT'D)
Then we'll execute tomorrow.

Peter rises. Kaan flinches. *Tomorrow?*

PETER (CONT'D)
Is that a problem?

Kaan quickly shakes his head. Peter rises.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. Because if you fuck me, I will burn your life to the ground.
(gripping Kaan's shoulder)
Let's save some fucking trees.

Kaan forces a smile to hide a gulp.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - FAR ROWS - DAY

Sezen walks through the trees. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN
I'm busy.

KAAN (PHONE)
I just wanted to let you know I looked into Terrasource. And I'm impressed. But we need to be careful. We can't be test rabbits.

SEZEN
We're running out of time.

KAAN (PHONE)
I know that. I do. But these R&D contracts are complicated. One vague clause and they own everything on our soil. Forever.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan peeks into Peter's office.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Listen. I can come home next month. We'll look at it together.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You're coming home?

KAAN
Isn't that what you want?

SEZEN (PHONE)
I'm handling things on my own.

KAAN
But you don't have to. You already do too much.

Silence. Kaan bites his lip. Waiting. Getting nothing.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Just don't let Baba sign anything. We'll do this as a family.

The waiting continues. Painfully.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales. Hangs up. Smiles, relieved.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen hangs up, thinking.

ROB (O.S.)
Everything okay?

She looks at Rob, on a ladder, sawing dead limbs off a tree. The dead limb drops at her feet.

SEZEN
You tell me.

Rob cuts the diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB
These strains are what, 500 years old? A thousand? They have no natural defense against this.
(beat)
Can you ask Musa to pass that?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN
He knows some English.

MUSA
My sister. Teach.

SEZEN
So what happens now? You just replace the top?

ROB
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees come and go. But the roots are basically immortal. We're just giving them the best of the foreign stock so they can battle the disease and keep growing.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

Just then, Musa notices a green Turkish JANDARMA TRUCK grumbles toward the house. He taps Sezen.

SEZEN
(to Rob)
Stay up there. Don't move.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
(whispering to Musa)
House. Go. Quiet.

MUSA
But Davut Bey--

SEZEN
Just go.

Musa runs low through the trees toward the back door.

DRIVEWAY - MOMENTS LATER

The truck stops besides Rob's car. Two JANDARMA SOLDIERS climb out. Then the COMMANDER from the border station.

Sezen approaches from the grove, wiping her hands.

COMMANDER
İyi günler, may I speak with the owner of the property?

SEZEN
How can I help you, Commander?

COMMANDER
You're the owner?

SEZEN
He's ill. What's this about?

COMMANDER
A foreigner.

Sezen flinches. But he hands her a grainy photo. She peeks at it. It's not Rob and it's not Musa.

COMMANDER (CONT'D)
Tall, dark hair. Scar on neck. He was close by, at the border.

SEZEN
Is he dangerous?

He doesn't answer. But the answer is obvious.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - SAME

Musa crouches below the window, listening.

COMMANDER (O.S.)
Do you employ foreign laborers?

SEZEN (O.S.)
We don't bring on workers until the harvest. For now, it's just me.

Musa looks at the bedroom door, where Davut sleeps.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DRIVEWAY - SAME

The Commander gives Sezen a long skeptical look.

COMMANDER
Just you?

SEZEN
That's right, Commander. But I'll be certain to let you know if I see anyone suspicious.

The Commander continues looking at her. Then he turns to Rob's car, parked next to his truck. Peers inside...for a long time. Seems to inspect every detail.

COMMANDER
My son has the same car. It's a very reliable vehicle.

He gets back into his truck. The Soldiers follow.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - SAME

Musa hears the engine start and the truck drive away.

Then the door opens. Sezen looks at him.

MUSA
Me?

Sezen shakes her head. Then shows him the photo the Commander left her, a grainy still from the drone footage:

SEZEN
Him. Whoever he is.

Abe at the fire pit. Face obscured. Scar on his neck.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe stares at destruction out the window as Will drives away from the lush coast. Into the heat of the desert.

A BARREL BOMB hits a hillside in the distance.

Abe winces.

WILL
You gonna shit your pants? I thought they pulled you from Iraq.

ABE
I'll be fine.

Will snorts as he pulls over to a CHECKPOINT.

WILL
Don't speak too soon.

GUN BARRELS tap the glass.

The truck is surrounded by masked gunmen.

Will calmly puts the window down. Drops a black bag outside. There's some fumbling with the bag.

GUNMAN
What the fuck is this?

Then a GUNMAN dumps the bag.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)
No Kit Kats?

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL
Bring us in and you get the rest.

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch.

Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers. Chocolate on his breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead. Breathes.

Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

REBEL COMPOUND

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact.

A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.

The Guard waves them through the gate.

EXT. REBEL COMPOUND - LOADING AREA - DAY

The truck is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food. Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate-looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby. Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL
You really can't wait?

ABE
(walking off)
I've been waiting all day.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - A FEW MINUTES LATER

FLUSH. Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles. A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

HALLWAY

where children's drawings line the walls.

He peeks inside a:

CLASSROOM

and finds old educational posters. Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just left for recess.

Then he notices, on the wall:

A FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script. The black flag of Jihad.

His mind flashes. Jaw tightens.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens.

Hears A CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor. What?

He opens the door to a:

STORAGE ROOM

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against a wall. Teens, at most.

CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)
What are you doing!?

Big FIGHTER appears to his left. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL
He's lost--

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER
I asked you--

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE
Fuck.

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT III

OVER BLACK:

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises.

The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat.

Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned. It's late afternoon.

SEZEN
Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?
(off silence)
I should call the doctor--

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT
I'm fine. I have work to do--

SEZEN
I did everything. I swear. I'm taking care of it.

He looks in her eyes. Then shakes off the dream.

DAVUT
I know I am...like vinegar. It is hard being trapped inside my mind.
(pained breath)
All I see is death.

SEZEN
I know, Baba.

DAVUT
I hope you don’t.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY

Abe is bound and gagged.

Bloody crack on his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

REBEL
You can’t be in here.

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL
Didn’t your commander tell you who the fuck I am?

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun.

WILL (CONT'D)
Let’s go.

He pulls Abe off the floor.

WILL (CONT'D)
Fucking idiot.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

The door eases open. Bare feet on wood.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - CONTINUOUS

Davut steps into the low sun. Heads for the grove.

STONE WALL

Musa sees him. Jumps up. Looks to the far rows: Rob at the top of his ladder. No Sezen.

Davut’s already passing him.

Musa steps into his path.

Davut stops. Those old eyes.

DAVUT
Move.

Musa doesn't.

MUSA
You no eat.

Davut squints. Musa tries Turkish:

MUSA
Hungry. You.

Musa pulls a fig from his pocket. Splits it. Holds out half.

Davut looks at the fig. Then the boy. Takes it. A labored breath. Musa helps him sit on the wall.

It's a long uncomfortable silence as Davut's mind wanders. He looks down at the fig.

DAVUT
My father planted these. He brought life to this land.

MUSA
We have trees too.

DAVUT
I don't understand you.

Musa doesn't understand, either. He answers in Arabic.

MUSA
They burned.

Davut studies him. Then puts a caring hand on his cheek.

DAVUT
Your eyes. They're too old for a child. What have you seen?

DEEPER IN THE GROVE

Sezen hurries between the trees, arms full of scion wood. Stops dead when she sees:

Davut and Musa on the wall. Backs to the grafts. Sharing a fig. After a moment, Davut heads back toward the house.

Musa catches her eye. The smallest nod.

INT. HEDGE FUND - MORNING

CLINK! Kaan taps a coffee cup to Jimmy's across their desks.

KAAN
To surviving another day.

JIMMY
What time's the trade hitting?

KAAN
Whenever Peter pulls the trigger.
(big sip)
I already have to shit.

Kaan sets down the mug. Heads to the bathroom. Moments later:

PETER (O.S.)
Jimmy.

Peter calls over from his office.

PETER'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy steps in and finds:

PETER
You know Michael Waller, our Chief Compliance Officer.

A suited COMPLIANCE OFFICER sits on the sofa. Doesn't smile.

PETER (CONT'D)
Let's talk Turkey.

Peter closes the door behind him.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - EVENING

Sezen leaves rice and chicken by Davut's bedside. The old man is deep asleep.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen heads down the hill to Rob, who's still on the ladder, finishing a final graft.

ROB
Is your father happy?

SEZEN
Not since I was 12.

ROB
(chuckle)
Well. This should be the last one.
Then I can get out of your hair.

SEZEN
You must be starving.

ROB
Oh, no thank you--

SEZEN
That wasn't a question.

Rob smiles. Then tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

—-through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rifle.

WILL (O.S.)
Do you know what the market is like
for Americans here? Especially with
your record.

ABE
Did you know?

Will ties off a suture. Ignoring the question.

ABE (CONT'D)
Did. You. Know.

The needle stops.

WILL
I warned you about the good guys.
We don't choose our friends out
here. We choose our enemies.

Sigh. Will digs the needle back into Abe's skin.

WILL (CONT'D)
I didn't know about any girls.

ABE
But you knew they’re al-Qaeda.

WILL
Not anymore. This is new crazy.

ABE
And you’re giving them rocket launchers.

WILL
No, Coyote. You’re giving them rocket launchers.

The needle slips into Abe’s head. Releasing some truth.

ABE
I’m insurance.

WILL
You think they’d send a guy like you for a job like this?

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)
It’s Will by the way.
(eye contact in mirror)
You don’t need to show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch. Barks to the hallway:

WILL
Leyla!

Leyla rushes inside.

WILL (CONT'D)
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Will heads to the hall to answer the phone.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

Leyla grabs some gauze. Abe looks up at her.

ABE
Thank you.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call.

LEYLA
What he says?

Abe squints. What? Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA
“Shh”.

ABE
Oh. He’s just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe’s head.

LEYLA’S ROOM

Will takes the call inside Leyla’s room.

WILL
Sounds good. I’ll see you soon.

As he hangs up, something catches his eye. Her English book. Open on the desk.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere.

ROB
To home.

Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Rakı bottle. Two glasses. They clink their glasses.

SEZEN
Where's that for you?

ROB
Pennsylvania. But these days, I guess it’s wherever Terrasource wants to fund my work.

SEZEN
So you trust them?

ROB
I don’t really have a choice. It’s that or let all of this die.

He looks across the grove. At the trees.

ROB (CONT'D)
You ever think about leaving?

SEZEN
I actually did a semester at UT. Hook 'em.

ROB
Seriously? Why'd you come back?

SEZEN
My mom.

Oh. She takes a long drink. He stays quiet.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Someone had to come back to take care of him. Of this.

ROB
They're lucky to have you.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Shower running steamy water. Abe hops in. Careful to avoid his bandaged head. His scar runs from his throat, across his chest. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

LEYLA'S ROOM - SAME

Downstairs, Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

WILL (O.S.)
I'm so impressed with you.

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)
English. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like "appreciate".

LEYLA
Thanking.

WILL
Right. But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.)(CONT'D)
So when I say "I appreciate you", I could mean "I am thankful for you". Or, I could be saying...that I'm considering your worth. And Leyla--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)
You're worth nothing to me dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA
I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL
Enough.

His eyes flash as he rises.

WILL (CONT'D)
They're gone. All of them.

Tears run down her cheeks.

WILL (CONT'D)
I'm the only one who can protect you now.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL (CONT'D)
Do you understand me?

He touches her cheek. Then leaves. She picks up the family photo from the floor.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob reaches for Sezen's hand, but BUZZING from his pocket.

ROB
Sorry.
(rising, checking phone)
It's the...it's the legal team.
(stepping away, answering)
Rob Green.

He listens. His face drains of color.

ROB (CONT'D)
No. I would never share proprietary information. I don’t even know any hedge fund traders.
(listening, clamming up)
Who’s Kaan?

He slowly turns to Sezen. She goes cold.

INT. HEDGE FUND - KITCHEN - DAY

Kaan’s selecting some fiber snacks when his phone BUZZES in his pocket. It’s Sezen. He smiles.

KAAN
Hey. I was just thinking about you.

SEZEN (PHONE)
What the fuck did you do?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen watches Rob’s car pull away, bottle of rakı still in her hand. Taillights disappear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Terrasource thinks Rob gave you insider information. He could lose his job. Because of you.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. I don’t understand.

INT. HEDGE FUND - KITCHEN - SAME

Kaan’s frazzled. Impatient in the long silence.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You will.

She hangs up. Kaan looks out the door, onto the main floor:

Peter’s at his desk. Flanked by two SECURITY GUARDS.

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

Demir’s finally getting a minute of sleep when his phone rings. He answers it slowly. Listens.

DEMIR
You emailed it?
(beat)
Give me a moment.

He hurries to his laptop. Checks his email.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
That's him. The man at the border.

On the laptop: a photo of ABE from the port.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
The man from the border.

Demir crosses to the wall. Finds the first photo of Abe from the drone footage. With the neck scar.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - SAME

Abe under running water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I need to talk to him.

Abe OPENS his eyes.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.)(CONT'D)
***Before* they torture him to death.**

MARCY
(under breath)
Fuck.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will checks ammo in his handgun. Holsters it.

Grabs his phone, makes a call. Mumbles in Arabic. Listens.

Then hangs up and walks back toward the house.

GUEST BATHROOM

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)
Get out.
(beat)
Syrian Mukhabarat are on their way.

ABE
Why do you care? I'm only here in case something goes wrong.

He grabs a towel. Heads for the door, phone to his ear.

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote.

GUEST BEDROOM

Someone steps in, approaches the bathroom door.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Something has gone wrong.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Silence on the other line.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Coyote?

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Outside the bathroom door, Abe puts his hands up.

Phone drops. Marcy's voice muffled on the carpet:

MARCY (V.O.)
Coyote, are you there?

A KNIFE presses into his throat.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Coyote. Say something!

Leyla kicks the phone away. Keeps the knife on Abe. Uses her other hand to put a finger to her lips:

LEYLA
Shh.

ACT IV

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan eyes the Security Guards as he approaches Peter.

KAAN
Peter. What's going on?

PETER
I'm making a scene. So this never happens again.

KAAN
What are you talking about?

PETER
I'm talking about trading on material nonpublic information.

KAAN
I didn't--

PETER
(booming)
Shut the fuck up.

The floor goes quiet. Everyone's paying attention now.

PETER (CONT'D)
I know about your friend at Terrasource. I know about *Rob.*

Kaan finds Jimmy, nervous, in the crowd.

PETER (CONT'D)
Don't look at Jimmy. He had an ethical duty to tell me. And I was obligated to call Terrasource.
(beat)
They told me about the contract.

Kaan stammers a confused response but--

PETER (CONT'D)
Don't bullshit me. Your father signed a deal to test their unannounced product *the same day* you pitched me on the trade. Is that supposed to be a coincidence?

KAAN
It's not true. My father wouldn't--

PETER
I don’t give a fuck about your father, Kaan. I care about federal crimes being committed in my name.

KAAN
You have to listen to me--

PETER
No, I don’t. You are no longer my problem, because I no longer employ you. And I certainly don’t sponsor your visa. Now get the fuck out.

Kaan looks back for Jimmy. He’s gone.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Leyla holds the knife at Abe’s throat.

LEYLA
The man sells you. Tonight.

ABE
Why are you telling me this?

LEYLA
So you leave.

She steps back, but keeps the knife pointed to him.

LEYLA (CONT'D)
And bring me. You owe.

ABE
He’ll kill us both. I can’t protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)
Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA
Stay.

She heads into the hall.

Abe exhales. Goes to the window. Opens it. Cool air rushes in. He looks back at the door to the hall.

INT. HEDGE FUND - BATHROOM - DAY

Kaan barrels in. Searching.

KAAN
Jimmy!

Checks every stall one by one. Spots feet.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I see you.

He rips the door open. Finds the terrified Jimmy.

KAAN (CONT'D)
You ruined my fucking life.

Kaan tackles him backward against the wall. Within seconds--

Security Guards run in and wrestle Kaan to the floor.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Abe drops out of the window to the ground. Bag on shoulders.

Heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

Abe spins. Low. Fast. But--

The CATTLE PROD is already in his ribs.

ZAP. Abe hits the dirt. Every muscle locked.

WILL
Careful. There's jackals out here.

Will stands over him. Prod in one hand, gun in the other. He zaps Abe again. Longer. Abe stops moving.

Will kicks the bag away.

WILL (CONT'D)
You did this to yourself. Making a mess everywhere you go. Poor fucking spycraft, if you ask me.

Checks him for weapons. Then pulls out ROPES.

ABE
(straining to speak)
I'm not a spy.

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. Knots them. Fast.

WILL
No.

Will sets Abe down against a tree. Runs the rope around the trunk. Cinches it.

WILL (CONT'D)
You're a prisoner.

He tosses the cattle prod into the leaves.

WILL (CONT'D)
It'll be alright.
(beat)
Just breathe.

As he tucks the gun into his pants--

ZAP--

Will convulses. Drops. The gun falls in the dirt.

LEYLA stands over him. Cattle prod in her hand.

LEYLA
You owe. More now.

From below, Abe sees the scar on Leyla's ankle. Like a chain.

As she reaches for the gun in the dirt--

Will grabs her ankle and YANKS.

She crashes onto fallen branches. Gashing her arm.

Abe pulls. The rope doesn't give.

WILL
What are you doing?

Will crawls on top of Leyla. Sits on her chest.

WILL
You think he can protect better than me? He's a fucking war criminal they fished out of prison. Someone to burn if things go bad.
(back to English, to Abe)
Tell her.

Abe looks into Leyla's eyes. A long silence.

ABE
Your brother’s alive.

Will snaps to Abe.

Leyla’s hand finds a branch.

WILL
What the fuck?

LEYLA STABS Will’s neck with the branch.

BLOOD spurts from his jugular.

He falls forward onto Leyla. His full weight trapping her.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - EVENING

Kaan’s LAWYER sits with him at a plain desk.

LAWYER
They're giving you a desk ticket. You'll be out tonight. Court date's in two months.

KAAN
I need to get back to my family.

LAWYER
If you leave the country now, you’re never getting back in.

KAAN
Just get me a fucking phone.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT’S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Davut’s phone sings and glows. He rustles awake. Answers:

KAAN (PHONE)
Baba. Did you sign a contract? With that American company?
(beat)
Or was it her?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen sits alone on the stone wall, drunk. The rakı bottle. Two glasses. She drinks from Rob’s.

Behind her, the back door opens.

She doesn’t turn around. Pours another.

DAVUT

crosses the yard in nightclothes. Phone in breast pocket.

EQUIPMENT SHED

Davut opens the wooden chest. Pushes aside the old revolver. Grabs the AXE.

MUSA’S TENT

Musa wakes to crunching leaves.

Davut’s shadow passes over the tent. The shadow of the axe looks enormous in the moonlight.

EXT. WILL’S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla trapped under Will's body. Blood drips on her face.

She pushes. Can’t move him. Can barely breathe.

ABE

pulls at the ropes. Nothing.

Then he stops. His eyes on the trees behind Leyla.

ABE
Don’t move.

LEYLA

hears the PANTING. Getting closer.

She can’t turn her head. But she can feel the HOT BREATH on her head. Then--

A JACKAL’s face appears above her.

It licks Will’s blood from his neck.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

She cries with no sound, staring upward at the jackal’s yellow eyes. Teeth. A low GROWL from its throat.

ABE

hisses and grunts, trying to get the jackal's attention. When it finally looks up, Abe notices: a bullet wound in its side.

The jackal holds its eyes on Abe for a moment.

As it lowers it's head back down to Leyla's face--

Its ears perk up.

HEADLIGHTS sweep through the trees.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway. Doors open and close.

DRIVEWAY

Three SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS drag their flashlights around the dark house.

OFFICER 1
They said he'd be back here.

They proceed back into the:

OLIVE GROVE

where Leyla can see the flashlights illuminating the rows. Getting closer.

The jackal is gone.

THE OFFICERS

stop. Listen to RUSTLING in the trees.

A flashlight swings to a trunk. Lands on:

YELLOW EYES.

OFFICER 1
What the--

The jackal LUNGES at the Officer. BITES his forearm.

He SCREAMS. The flashlight drops.

LEYLA

hears the SNARLING. Screaming. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 2 (O.S.)
Get him to the truck! I'll find the American.

The flashlights jerk wildly through the trees.

One swings after the jackal, away from Leyla.

ABE
(whisper)
Now. Let's go.

Leyla pushes upward, but he's too heavy.

The flashlight turns in their direction.

ABE (CONT'D)
Leyla. Hurry.

She wedges her knee under Will's hip. Rocks the body.

Once. Twice. Teeth bared.

Finally, Will THUDS onto the dirt.

The beam whips toward the sound.

She freezes. It sweeps the next row over. Moves on.

ABE (CONT'D)
Just go.

But Leyla climbs to her knees. Then to Abe. Tears at the knot behind the trunk. Then the one at his wrists.

THE OFFICER

reaches the tree.

Leyla and Abe are gone.

It's just Will, lying face down in a pool of blood.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen stares into the grove. Lifts her glass when she hears--

CHOPPING in the distance.

She drops down off the wall. Unsteady.

CHOP CHOP

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

SEZEN
Baba?

CHOPPING getting louder as she finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Baba, stop--

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

She grabs the axe. He doesn't let go.

DAVUT
My name. My father's name. You put it on a lie. Brought foreign poison into our grove--

Sezen doesn't respond. He grips his chest in agony.

SEZEN
I'm saving it--

DAVUT
Stupid child. You left us for the wolves.

He RIPS the axe away from her. Some unknown strength.

DAVUT
Where is it?

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

Catches himself on the trunk. Breathing hard. Looks around wildly. Then he sees it.

DAVUT
There.

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK. The axe splits through the graft joint. Foreign wood splinters.

SEZEN
Baba. Please. Listen to me--

CRACK. Davut's axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

SEZEN
(crying now)
You're going to kill it.

DAVUT
It's already dead!

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing. They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

SEZEN
You said - you said we have to make hard choices. For our family.

He stops. Looks at her.

DAVUT
You are not my family.

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back. Raises the axe high over the graft--

Sezen grabs his ankle. Holds it.

Then YANKS.

Davut's weak body can't compensate. He bends forward and--

CRACKS his head against the tree trunk.

A sickening sound.

His body slides down against the trunk. Crumples at the foot of the tree. Blood pours from the front of his head...

...down the bark.

Silence.

SEZEN
Baba?

She rolls to get up. Her right arm doesn't come with her.

She screams into her teeth. Looks down. The shoulder sits wrong. Out of its socket.

She tries again. Left arm only. Gets a knee under her. The ground tilts and she goes down on her face. Dirt in her teeth. His blood on the ground, inches away.

No one is coming.

She stops. Lays her cheek on the ground. And closes her eyes.

The TREE above her RUSTLES. Her eyes open.

She digs her elbow in. Drags herself a foot closer.

Reaches for Davut’s sleeve. Falls short.

Lunges forward. Finally grabs his shirt.

She rolls Davut onto his back.

She bends over him. Breathes into his mouth. Pumps his chest with her working arm. One. Two. Three.

SEZEN
Come on. Come on.

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Baba. Please.

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Baba.

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - MOUNTAIN ROAD - NIGHT

Headlights carve a switchback toward the border.

Demir drives one-handed. Phone to his ear.

DEMIR
I said I need him alive.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it.

Drives faster.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - NIGHT

Marcy monitors Demir’s call.

CONTACT (PHONE)
That’s up to God now.

She tosses the headset. Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY
He’s gone.

VOICE (PHONE)
And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)
You knew the risk. He’s not ours.
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY
I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Zips her bag.

EXT. SYRIAN HILLSIDE - NIGHT

Abe and Leyla climb through the trees.

Far below, flashlights cross Will’s grove.

ABE
(gasping for breath)
Thank you.

Leyla doesn’t respond. Abe grabs her arm.

She swings back to him but he puts his hands up. Then carefully pulls out a cloth from his bag. Unwraps the wild yarrow. Holds up Leyla’s gashed arm.

He packs the open wound with the flowers. Ties the cloth around it tightly.

LEYLA
Now?

ABE
Your brother. Will said he’s working on an olive grove. Somewhere in Turkey.

LEYLA
Hatay.

Abe nods. Then starts walking toward the dark mountains.

ABE
Hurry. We need to get over the border before daybreak.

She doesn't follow yet.

LEYLA
I'm coming for you...

Just looks up at the moon hanging over the mountain.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

The same moon on the other side of the mountains. Shining onto Musa.

LEYLA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
...Musa.

He hides behind a tree. Watching Sezen. Finally, she notices he's been standing there. Eye contact. *What did he see?*

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Nothing. Then feels it against her, in Davut's breast pocket.

She looks back at Musa.

Puts her finger to her lips. Shh.

INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT

Kaan waits in line, phone to ear. The call is answered.

KAAN
Baba?

No response.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Baba. I'm on my way home.

Still no response.

But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove. It settles him.

KAAN (CONT'D)
We can fix this.

SEZEN (PHONE)
No. We can’t.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Sezen hangs up Davut’s phone.

Then holds him tight in her lap.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response.

And for the first time this year...

...the branches seem to grow.

HOWLING in the distance.

CUT TO BLACK.